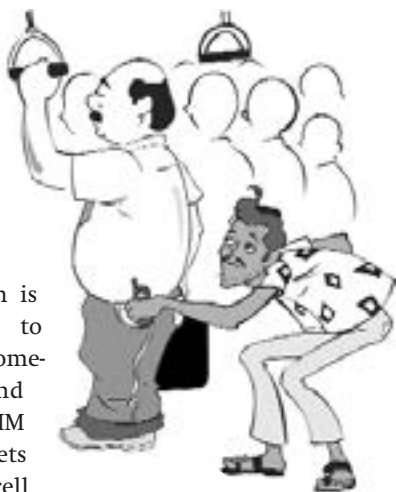


to block your handset, so even if the thief changes the SIM card, your phone will be useless. If this practice were universally followed, no mobile phones would get stolen!

Another area of concern is 'cloning', the term used to describe calls charged to someone's account illegally and fraudulently. If you're a SIM card user, if your phone gets stolen or lost, contact your cell phone service provider immediately and have the service suspended before you get an inflated bill.



The mobile phone is now part of the average person's personality. Users customise and accessorise their cell phones. Ring tones play a crucial role in the personalisation of the cell phone. And now, there are also caller tunes - songs or any other music that you can choose to play for the listener while he or she waits. Some even change the faceplate to match the colour of the phone to that of their clothes!

And no cell phone is complete without the right accessories. Practical accessories enhance cell phone usage. Popular accessories include hands-free headsets, batteries, and car chargers. Bluetooth hands-free headsets are also getting popular. And with a USB data cable, users can easily transfer data from their phone to a computer and vice versa.

Then there's the digital camera feature. Apart from sharing photos with friends and family, mobiles also enable citizens keep guard. Anyone with a camera phone can click instant pictures of events that can be used in breaking news stories - for instance, the hurricanes in America and the London Bombings.